

Elisa Jácome

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Academic Positions

Assistant Professor of Economics, Northwestern University, 2022–
Postdoctoral Fellow, SIEPR, Stanford University, 2021–2022

Affiliations

Faculty Research Fellow, National Bureau of Economic Research (NBER)
Faculty Fellow, Institute for Policy Research, Northwestern University
Visiting Scholar, Federal Reserve Bank of Chicago
Faculty Affiliate, Abdul Latif Jameel Poverty Action Lab (J-PAL)

Education

Ph.D. in Economics, Princeton University, 2015–2021
M.A. in Economics, Princeton University, 2017
B.S. in International Economics (*summa cum laude*), Georgetown University, 2009–2013

Research Fields

Primary	Labor economics, public economics
Secondary	Economic history, economics of crime, health economics

Peer-Reviewed Publications

“Mobility for All: Representative Intergenerational Mobility Estimates over the 20th Century”
with Ilyana Kuziemko and Suresh Naidu,
Journal of Political Economy, Vol. 133. 2025.

“Law-Abiding Immigrants: The Incarceration Gap Between Immigrants and the US-born, 1870–2020”
with Ran Abramitzky, Leah Boustan, Santiago Pérez, and Juan David Torres,
American Economic Review: Insights, Vol. 6. 2024 (Lead Article).

“Intergenerational Mobility of Immigrants in the US over Two Centuries”
with Ran Abramitzky, Leah Boustan, and Santiago Pérez,
American Economic Review 111(2): 580–608. 2021.

“The Effect of Immigration Enforcement on Crime Reporting: Evidence from Dallas.”
Journal of Urban Economics, Vol. 128. 2022.

Working Papers

“Community Engagement and Public Safety: Evidence from Crime Enforcement Targeting Immigrants”
with Felipe Gonçalves and Emily Weisburst (NBER WP #32109)
Forthcoming at *American Economic Review*

“Mental Health and Criminal Involvement: Evidence from Losing Medicaid Eligibility”

Revisions requested at *American Economic Journal: Applied Economics*

Intergenerational Mobility of Immigrants in 15 Destination Countries

with Leah Boustan, Mathias Fjællegaard Jensen, Ran Abramitzky, Alan Manning, Santiago Pérez, Analysis Watley, Adrian Adermon, Jaime Arellano-Bover, Olof Aslund, Marie Connolly, Nathan Deutscher, Anne C. Gielen, Yvonne Giesing, Yajna Govind, Martin Halla, Dominik Hangartner, Yuyan Jiang, Cecilia Karmel, Fanny Landaud, Lindsey Macmillan, Isabel Z. Martínez, Alberto Polo, Panu Poutvaara, Hillel Rapoport, Sara Roman, Kjell G. Salvanes, Shmuel San, Michael Siegenthaler, Louis Sirugue, Javier Soria Espín, Jan Stuhler, Giovanni L. Violante, Dinand Webbink, Andrea Weber, Jonathan Zhang, Angela Zheng, & Tom Zohar (NBER WP #33558)

Revisions requested at *American Economic Review*

“The Effect of Mass Incarceration on Black Women” (Resting Paper)

Other Writing

“How Tougher Immigration Enforcement Can Undermine Public Safety” (with Felipe Gonçalves and Emily Weisburst), *Briefing Book*, 2026

“Can Heightened Immigration Enforcement Increase Crime?” (with Felipe Gonçalves and Emily Weisburst), *Econofact*, 2025

“Law-Abiding Immigrants: The Incarceration Gap between Immigrants and the US-Born, 1870–2020” (with Ran Abramitzky, Juan David Torres, Leah Platt Boustan, & Santiago Pérez), *Cato Institute Research Briefs in Economic Policy*, 2024

“Immigration Enforcement and Public Safety” (with Felipe Gonçalves and Emily Weisburst), *Cato Institute Research Briefs in Economic Policy*, 2024

“How better access to mental health care can reduce crime”, *Stanford Institute for Economic Policy Research Policy Brief*, 2021

“Profiles of change: Employment, earnings, and occupations from 1990–2013” (with Melissa S. Kearney and Brad Hershbein), *The Hamilton Project*, 2015

“Ten Economic Facts about Crime and Incarceration in the United States” (with Melissa S. Kearney, Benjamin H. Harris, and Lucie Parker), *The Hamilton Project*, 2014

“A Dozen Facts about America’s Struggling Lower-Middle Class” (with Melissa Kearney, Benjamin Harris, and Lucie Parker), *The Hamilton Project*, 2013

Professional Activities

Referee for *Quarterly Journal of Economics*, *American Economic Review*, *Journal of Political Economy*, *Review of Economic Studies*, *American Economic Journal: Applied Economics*, *American Economic Journal: Economic Policy*, *Journal of Public Economics*, *American Economic Review: Insights*, *Journal of Urban Economics*, *Review of Economics and Statistics*, *Journal of Human Resources*, *Journal of the European Economic Association*, *Explorations in Economic History*, *The Journal of Law and Economics*, *Review of Economics of the Household*, *Economic Journal*, *Journal of Policy Analysis and Management*, *The B.E. Journal of Economic Analysis and Policy*, *Journal of Quantitative Criminology*, *Eastern Economic Journal*, *Labour Economics*, *Crime, Law, and Social Change*, *World Development*

Organizer Kellogg Labor Seminar at Northwestern University, 2023–
Health, Education, Labor, and Public (“HELP”) Seminar at Northwestern University, 2022–
Society of Labor Economists Conference (Program Committee Member), 2026
Women in Empirical Microeconomics Conference, 2024 and 2025
Interactions: Bringing Together Econometrics & Applied Microeconomics Conference, 2023
Stanford Institute for Theoretical Economics (SITE) Migration Conference, 2022

Grant review Arnold Ventures
National Science Foundation
Abdul Latif Jameel Poverty Action Lab (J-PAL) North America
Russell Sage Foundation
Alfred P. Sloan Foundation

Discussant Final Seminar, University of Gothenburg, 2025
NBER Labor Studies Spring Meeting, 2023
American Economic Association Annual Meeting 2023
Explorations in Economic History, 2023

U.S. Census Bureau Special Sworn Status, 2019–present
Transactional Records Access Clearinghouse (TRAC) Research Fellow, 2018–2026
Becker Friedman Institute Price Theory Camp, 2019
Graduate Student Summit for Diversity in Economics, 2018

Research Grants

Arnold Ventures Grant (\$3,992,488), 2026–2030
Project: Interventions to Support Domestic Violence Survivors in Cook County
Co-PIs: Abi Adams, Fatemeh Momeni, & Zubin Jelveh

Arnold Ventures Planning Grant (\$112,356), 2026
Project: Cash Transfers for Survivors of Gender-Based Violence
Co-PI: Abi Adams

The Alumnae of Northwestern University Grant (\$5,000), 2026
Upjohn Institute Early Career Research Award, 2025

Arnold Ventures Planning Grant (\$211,041), 2025
Project: Interventions to Support Domestic Violence Survivors in Cook County
Co-PIs: Abi Adams & Zubin Jelveh

Arnold Ventures Planning Grant (\$85,260), 2025
Project: The Criminal and Economic Impacts of an Arrest
Co-PIs: Eric Chyn, Felipe Gonçalves, Steve Mello, & Emily Weisburst

Northwestern Provost Grants for Research in Humanities, Social Sciences and the Arts (\$5,000), 2024
Northwestern Institute for Policy Research Seed Grant (\$4,525), 2023
Russell Sage Foundation Grant, 2021–2023
UCLA Ziman Center for Real Estate Grant, 2020–2021

Awards & Fellowships

Malmsten Early Career Scholar (MECS), Department of Economics, University of Gothenburg, 2025–2027
Fellowship of SPIA Scholars, 2019–2021
Marimar and Cristina Torres Prize for Best Third Year Paper, 2018
Paul & Daisy Soros Fellowship for New Americans Finalist, 2017
Princeton University Graduate Fellowship, 2015–2021
Industrial Relations Section Graduate Fellowship, 2015–2017
William F. Notz Medal for Economics, 2013
Phi Beta Kappa, 2013

Conferences & Invited Seminars

2026 Federal Reserve Bank of Chicago, Chicago Health Economics Workshop (CHEW), Oxford Applied Microeconomics Seminar, London School of Economics Applications Seminar, Society of Labor Economists Conference, NBER Economics of Health Summer Institute
2025 Federal Reserve Bank of New York, Princeton University Workshop on the Intergenerational Mobility of Immigrants
2024 ASSA, Northwestern IPR, Northwestern Law, MIT Applied Economics Seminar, UC Santa Barbara, Research Network on Intergenerational Mobility, NBER Labor Studies Program Spring Meeting, George Washington University, Duke University Applied Micro Jamboree
2023 ASSA (discussant), Notre Dame, McMaster, NBER Immigrants and the U.S. Economy Conference, Harvard Economics, Inter-American Development Bank, NBER Labor Studies Program Spring Meeting (discussant), University of Toronto's Bissell-Heyd Conference on Race, Equity and Public Policy, BFI-LSE Conference on the Economics of Crime and Justice, Princeton Industrial Relations Section Centenary Symposium, Women in Empirical Microeconomics Conference, Explorations in Economic History (discussant), Purdue, University of Illinois Chicago, Federal Reserve Bank of Chicago, University of Wisconsin-Milwaukee
2022 ASSA, UC Merced, UC Berkeley, University of Chicago Becker Applied Economics, APPAM, MIT Applied Economics Seminar, BU/MIT/Harvard Health Economics Seminar, SITE Migration, Gothenburg, Stockholm SOFI, NYU Stern, University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign, UC Denver, Michigan, Yale
2021 NBER Health Care Meeting, NTA Conference, Iowa State University, Brookings Institution, NYU, Niskanen Center's Summer Panel Series, Policy Impacts Inaugural Conference, NBER Summer Institute, SIEPR Postdoctoral Fellows Conference, Northwestern University, Stanford University, University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill, University of Oxford, Yale School of Management, UC Santa Cruz, Chicago Harris, UCLA Anderson School of Management, University of Zurich, Cornell University, Federal Reserve Bank of Chicago, UC Berkeley, Federal Reserve Bank of New York, UT Austin, University of British Columbia, Institute for Fiscal Studies, Brown University, Duke University, U.S. Treasury
2019 Social Science History Association

Teaching Experience

Economics of Crime (Econ 344), Northwestern Department of Economics, 2026–
Graduate Labor Economics (Econ 440), Northwestern Department of Economics, 2023–
Economic Writing and Stata Workshop Instructor, Undergraduate Junior Independent Work, 2017–2019
Teaching Assistant for Prof. Leah Boustan, Undergraduate Junior Independent Work, 2017–2018

Teaching Assistant for Prof. Martin Evans, Introduction to Econometrics, 2012–2013

Teaching Assistant for Prof. Carol Rogers, Principles of Macroeconomics, 2012

Calculus Tutor for Mathematics Department, 2010–2011

Guest Lectures:

University of British Columbia PhD Labor Economics (Prof. Heather Sarsons), 2023–2025

UCLA PhD Labor Economics (Prof. Felipe Gonçalves), 2024

Stanford PhD Economic History (Prof. Ran Abramitzky), 2022

University of Pennsylvania Seminar in Criminal Justice (Prof. Aaron Chalfin), 2021

Graduate Student Advising (committee member)

2026 Elizabeth Jaramillo (Inter-American Development Bank)

2027 Therese Bonomo
 Sergio Lopez Araiza
 Giacomo Marcolin
 Myera Rashid

Other Research Experience

Policy Coordinator and Senior Research Assistant, The Hamilton Project, Brookings Institution, 2013–2015

Research Assistant, The World Bank Group, 2012

Last updated: June 21, 2026